

H/O – Standard Precautions Quick Reference

Day 2 | GA Healthcare Training & Consulting | Nurse Aide Training Program

Name: _____ Date: _____

Handwashing – When to Wash

- Before and after direct resident contact
- After removing gloves
- Before and after eating or preparing food
- After using the restroom
- After contact with blood, body fluids, or contaminated surfaces
- When moving from a contaminated to a clean area

Handwashing Steps (CDC Method)

1.	Wet hands with clean, running water (warm or cold).
2.	Apply soap and lather well, including backs of hands, between fingers, and under nails.
3.	Scrub for at least 20 seconds (hum 'Happy Birthday' twice).
4.	Rinse hands under clean, running water.
5.	Dry with a clean towel or air dry.
6.	Use the towel to turn off the faucet.

Personal Protective Equipment (PPE)

PPE Item	When to Use	Key Reminders
Gloves	Any contact with blood, body fluids, mucous membranes, or non-intact skin	Change between tasks; wash hands after removal
Gown	Anticipated contact with blood/body fluids or splashing	Remove before leaving room; gown is single-use
Mask	Procedures that may generate splashing or sprays	Ensure nose wire is fitted; dispose after use
Eye Protection	Risk of blood/fluid splash to eyes or face	Reusable goggles must be disinfected between uses

Donning (Putting On) PPE — In Order

- 1. Gown
- 2. Mask or Respirator
- 3. Eye Protection (goggles or face shield)
- 4. Gloves (pull over gown cuffs)

Doffing (Removing) PPE — In Order

- 1. Gloves (most contaminated — remove first)
- 2. Eye Protection
- 3. Gown
- 4. Mask (least contaminated — remove last)

- Wash hands immediately after each step.

Transmission-Based Precautions

Type	Route	Examples	Precautions
Contact	Direct/indirect touch	MRSA, C. diff, Wound infections	Gown + gloves; private room preferred
Droplet	Large droplets (>5 microns)	Influenza, COVID-19, Pertussis	Surgical mask; 3-ft distance minimum
Airborne	Small particles (<5 microns)	TB, Measles, Chickenpox	N95 respirator; negative pressure room

Quick Review Questions

1. List the 6 steps of handwashing in order:

2. Which PPE is removed first and why?
